GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

May 24th, 2025
Week 21
Volume 272, Issue 1186

Highlights:

- **People on the move.**
- **Tariffs again???**
- **Markets react.**
- **Freight cool.**
- **HKC delays.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"If everyone is thinking alike, then somebody isn't thinking."

– General George Patton

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

GMS PODCASTS!

GMS is pleased to announce a new social-media avenue to reach our readers on the go with the launch of **GMS Podcasts**, a brand-new series focused on the upcoming enforcement of the Hong Kong Convention as it goes live on June 26th, 2025, across all sub-continent ship recycling markets. GMS Podcasts will be an avenue to address increasingly important topics across the maritime and ship recycling spaces, bringing them to the fore for a wider audience with the help of the latest AI tools. **Episode 1 is now live** covering the origins of the HKC, the countries and people behind it, what a post June 26th world means for the future of ship recycling, and what ship owners should prepare for when they eventually decide to pull out their recycling charts. Be sure to tune in on your preferred platform(s) as below and follow us to be notified about upcoming shows and topics:

Spotify ‖ **Apple Podcast** ‖ **YouTube Music** ‖ **Amazon Music** ‖ **Podbean**

Out of the digital realm and into the real one, a new tariff session of testing international economies has once again reared its ugly head with Trump specifically targeting India's retaliatory tariffs with the WTO causing a mixed reaction in the sub-continent ship recycling destinations as the US. Dollar plummeted against the Indian Rupee this week and gained ground against Bangladeshi, Pakistani, and (of course) Turkish currencies by the time the week ended. But the tariff-high didn't end there as Trump once again announced 50% tariffs on the EU this week, showing just how unpredictable and volatile the global business atmosphere will remain under his administration for the news 3 years, 8 months, 1 week...

Global stock markets, ship recycling nation currencies, and commodity prices collectively took hits as a result of Trump's actions causing freight markets to cool even further this week, as smaller trading sectors failed the most and dragged the overall Baltic Exchange Dry Index down about 0.1% despite the larger dry sector making marginal gains, while containers and certain tanker segments also start to see declines of their own, further indicating what may be a busier inflow of tonnage over the second half of 2025. On the back of faltering global trade, oil futures too continue their retreat resulting in the barrel declining across the week, to register a minor improvement by the end of the week and still end at an overall lower level of USD 61.50/barrel.

On the ship recycling front, sub-continent markets are gradually entering the monsoon season on a weaker note, having faced political, regulatory, and currency issues, a war, and evolving tariff woes that continue to see prices recycling prices significantly cool since the peaks closer to USD 500/LDT witnessed earlier in the year. Bangladesh continues to endure delays and teething problems after the announcement that only HKC yards would be allowed to import vessels as currently only 9 yards are HKC certified and can obtain NOCs to import and at least 20 more trying to improve their infrastructure before the convention comes into force on June 26th. Pakistan meanwhile remains lagging behind with not a single yard HKC approved and all of this pressure building up at a time when Gadani remains empty, buyers struggle to remain price-competitive, and Gadani remains 2nd on the market rankings. India and Turkey? Read on…Turkey actually has a sale to report!

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 21 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

TIK TOK TAK(A)!

Taka tumbles.

Last week, the Bangladeshi government decided to let market forces dictate the value of the Taka, a move officiated by the terms and conditions of the current IMF Loan. This has seen the Taka fall 80 basis points and head nearly vertically towards BDT 122 (as the week ended) once again, ending it pennies short at BDT 121.80. And while the Taka suffocates Bangladesh's ship recycling fraternity on the one hand, local steel plate prices on the other flatlined at levels region $475/ton post-Eid - pre-market / NOC closures in April and levels steel levels opened nearly USD 100/Ton higher at about USD 577/Ton, whereafter, in keeping with the depreciation of the Taka also saw steel plate prices lose a whopping USD 21/Ton this week. As a result, the movement of the overall economy has been increasingly spelling out disaster for the interim government that has finally committed to a June 30th date for General Elections to be held, as overall faith and confidence in the current administration loses further points among the domestic populous.

Backlog delivering.

Notwithstanding the decline in plate prices, their current levels have certainly provided local recyclers with more than a buffer to present reasonable offers on available units under the present circumstances. However, with the HKC on the horizon, not as many local buyers have been able to bid on tonnage on account of missing HKC accreditations / inability to obtain No Objection Certificates (NoCs) on their incoming acquisitions until a certain rate of development has been confirmed by yard owners, as mandated by the recently formed Ship Recycling Board. And while several HKC yards have been approved over recent weeks - taking the total number of approved yards up to 9 – there are reportedly over 20 yards that are presently undergoing their inspections / approvals ahead of being able to get their respective NOCs once again.

Docs needed, delays ensue.

This inability to obtain NOCs saw a healthy backlog of vessels build up outside port limits across April and even May whilst yard inspections took place, causing severe delays for ship owners and cash buyers alike. And given just how busy Bangladesh's waterfront has been this week compared to its regional competition (8 ships and nearly 54K LDT), this market is certainly pushing the pedal to the floor with its acquisitions and even yard upgrades. But with all these regulatory changes come additional documentary requirements as now, a Ship Recycling Facility Plan (SRFPs), Ship Recycling Plan (SRPs), and even an Inventory of Hazardous Materials (IHMs) needs to be provided to, and approved by the ministry before NOCs can be granted, further highlighting that delays are all but guaranteed when getting vessels cleared inward, paid for, and eventually delivered.

Interesting June.

With only 9 yards currently able to bid on tonnage being introduced for sale at the bidding tables and many in Chattogram having filled their yards over the last couple of weeks, a bare minimum number of open buyers are not pursuing fresh units aggressively in the face of pending approvals, which has seen prices from Bangladesh start to cool as the focus falls on neighboring markets to pick up the slack. The onset of rains isn't helping local steel trade either as demand from steel mills itself remains curtailed, coupled with upcoming elections and a budget for the next FY leaves the potential for an interesting June lying in wait for this market.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

ALWAYS AVAILABLE!

Falling steel.

Despite declining vessel prices in Bangladesh and the recently established fragile peace with Pakistan holding ground for the time-being, Alang buyers have persisted in the market, able to secure any unit at prevailing rates and even pick up some of the slack from a recently slowing Bangladeshi market. Such a case saw several Hyundai-controlled MOSS type LNGs sold into India this week as the larger LDT HYUNDAI AQUAPIA (34,066 LDT) and HYUNDAI TECHNOPIA (34,046 LDT) were both fixed for a decent enbloc price basis an 'as is' Korea / Batam delivery respectively – in what is earmarking some of the freshest sales of the market. And given their pedigree and green requirements, these units are more than likely destined to end up in India, with Bangladesh's ongoing delays in having vessels cleared locally and a minimum number of currently open (Bangladeshi) recyclers.

LNGs sold.

India's economy, meanwhile, remains much stronger than its neighbouring competition and its fundamentals continue to take the opportunity to inflate and simultaneously deflate local sentiments as on the one hand, the Indian Rupee firmed an impressive 60 basis points to end the week at Rs. 85.06 against the U.S. Dollar, while on the other hand, local steel plate prices remain the lowest in the Indian sub-continent, plummeting a whopping USD 11/Ton this week alone, ensuring that tonnage hungry Alang prices will likely remain stagnated (for now). Alang also did not report a single fresh arrival this week and to make matters worse, there is reportedly not a single vessel idling outside awaiting entry. Certainly, a surprising week for Alang's anchorage given just how busy last week was in comparison.

HKC ready.

Yet, India remains comfortably in the lead with over 100 HKC approved yards, leaving the country a far more open and available market for owners and cash byers alike, albeit at lower levels than their competitors. India's economy also continues to flourish as a nation as it displaces Japan for the 4th place in global rankings of the world's largest economies, and forecasts have also set the rate of GDP growth at 7% when FY25 winds up, driving up national economic sentiment and firming the INR. Notwithstanding, despite an overall depreciated currency, declining steel plate prices, and ongoing global tariff concerns affecting the nation, Alang remains the go to destination for straightforward and prompt deliveries, far from the self-induced and ongoing delays being currently witnessed in Bangladesh.

Plate issues.

If India steel plate prices make a small jump in the coming weeks, Alang recyclers would be in an incredible position take in a majority of the tonnage that is likely to come available prior to June 26th and even thereafter, if Pakistan doesn't step up its HKC updates.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
HYUNDAI AQUAPIA	LNG	34,066	Undisclosed Price ('as is' Korea)
HYUNDAI TECHNOPIA	LNG	34,046	Undisclosed Price ('as is' Batam)

PAKISTAN

TOO LITTLE, TOO LATE!

Greater demand.

Some greater demand, pricing, and sense of urgency to acquire tonnage seems to be emerging from Pakistan given that there remains just about a month to go until the Hong Kong Convention comes into force on June 26th.

Unfortunately, these moves to acquire seem to be too little too late with undervalued (in Pakistan) LNGs make the rounds this week while yard infrastructure / HKC upgrades remain woefully uninitiated at a healthy majority of domestic ship recycling yards, which itself is likely to take many more months to even get to anywhere near HKC standards, far from even achieving their respective accreditations thereafter; meaning Pakistan is likely to be excluded in the short term (perhaps even the long term if HKC development doesn't pick up pace asap) from being proposed any units for recycling.

Inadequate.

Meanwhile, the ongoing ceasefire has kept domestic tensions high and domestic fundamentals deviated from their performances over recent weeks whereby local steel plate prices managed to miraculously firm up by about USD 4/Ton this week, all while the Pakistani Rupee appreciated notably towards the end of the week and still lost about 11 basis points overall, to clock out at PKR 281.84 against the U.S. Dollar with a high that breached PKR 283 mid-week.

At the Macro end of the nation's economic state, the IMF's recent tranche has certainly helped stabilize the Pakistani economy for the interim, whilst the Pakistani Prime Minister assured various chambers of commerce that steps are being taken to ensure easier access to business and financial loans and instruments. While this should certainly assist local recyclers with potential negotiations on active tonnage, it should provide further assistance to yard owners and help them fast track the necessary improvements needed at their respective yards.

Need to improve.

With the nation's upcoming budget for FY 2025 – 2026 due on June 2nd, 2026, hopefully some much-needed attention is heeded to one of the most capital-intensive and vital sectors of the nation and if any units are to destined head to Pakistan before the HKC comes into force, prices will need to improve much more so as to divert Far East tonnage away from Bangladesh, and even some of the dry bulk sales, or even take a bite out of the less preferred larger LDT LNGs from India. Sadly, for the Gadani market, their efforts at acquiring tonnage remain far from fruitful as Pakistan's recycling anchorage registers a 5th week of no arrivals.

2023 again?

Is it 2023 all over again?

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SURPRISE!

39.02.

As both India and Pakistan suffer dithering anchorages this week and tonnage fixtures remain non-existent for the Turkish market, this week, news of the Greek (ferry) giant Attica reportedly diverted another Ropax to Aliaga as the 1979 built Kriti I (about 12,850 MT) was towed to a Turkish recycler at a price of about USD 280/MT. Being EU-based and subject to the regulations of the EUSRR meant that the owners were compelled to commit the vessel at nearly USD 175/Ton below that of competing Indian. Certainly, a large value on a vessel this size.

Steel plate prices meanwhile remain relatively unchanged from those of last week, all whilst the grease on the soles of Turkish Lira continue to help its unabated slide as it fell nearly 50 basis points and closed the week out at a whopping TRY 39.02 against the U.S. Dollar. Although vessel prices have held for the time being, there is no telling where they will be when the Lira finally breaches past the dreaded psychological TRY 40 limit.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
KRITI I	RoPax	12,850	USD 280/MT

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 21 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	450 / LDT	470 / LDT	480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	440 / LDT	460 / LDT	470 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	430 / LDT	450 / LDT	460 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- ***Immunity to sleep deprivation -*** *No, they're not vampires, but people with a mutation of the DEC2 gene can fall short on sleep yet feel fine. For the 1 percent of the population with this mutation, around six hours a night is fine—an amount that after a few nights would wreck most people. Those with the condition are called familial natural short sleepers (FNSS), and experts believe that some famous people, such as Margaret Thatcher and Winston Churchill, may have had it.*
- ***Advanced color vision -*** *The average eye has three cones, which means you can recognize colors in the red, green, and blue spectrums. This means you can distinguish roughly a million different shades, according to the BBC. However, there are so-called tetrachromats who walk among us and have four cones in their eyes. They can see ultraviolet shades, allowing them to appreciate 100 million distinct colors. The rare vision anomaly is more common in women than men, and a lot of people don't even realize they have it. Don't miss these 20 obscure facts you never knew about the human body.*
- ***Flexible eyeballs -*** *Talk about a crazy party trick—globe luxation is an extremely rare condition in which your eyes can actually protrude out of their sockets. The ability comes with downsides: One study notes the condition results from causes such as "thyroid eye disease, shallow orbit, and floppy eyelid syndrome." It can also lead to optic neuropathy down the line, so people with the condition should see their eye doctor on a regular basis.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
June 07 – Bakri-Eid	May 24 – June 01 June 09 – June 17 June 22 – June 30

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
June 07 - 12 – Eid-ul-Azha	May 26 – May 29 June 11 – June 14 June 24 – June 27

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
May 31 – June 02 – Dragon Boat Holiday	June 05 – Day or Arafah June 06 - 09 – Eid-ul-Azha	June 05 – 09 – Kurban Bayrami

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of May 23, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Lord 17	2,583	General Cargo	Arrived May 11
2	Nirvana	9,623	Oil Tanker	Arrived May 07
Total Tonnage		**12,206**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of May 23, 2025

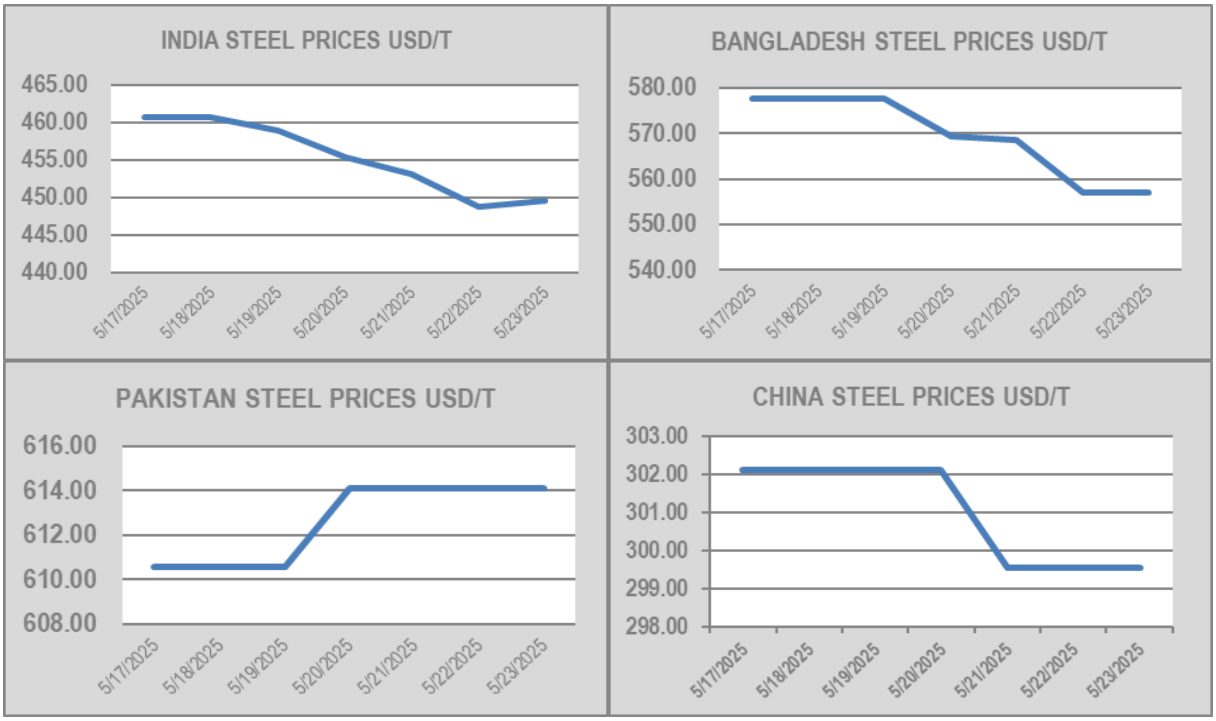
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Fianit	745	Fishing Vessel	Arrived May 21
2	*First 1*	*7,951*	*Woodchip Carrier*	*Delivered May 18*
3	Futong Express	8,857	Woodchip Carrier	Arrived May 22
4	Huaquan	1,413	Supply Vessel	Arrived May 16
5	Long 1	10,634	Woodchip Carrier	Arrived May 22
6	Sidimi	2,985	RoRo Cargo Vessel	Arrived May 16
7	*Vistar*	*10,683*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered May 17*
8	*Xie Hai*	*10,346*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered May 19*
		53,614		

GADANI - Port Position as of May 23, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
5/17/2025	460.76	39,400.00	610.58	172,000.00	577.56	70,000.00	302.12
5/18/2025	460.76	39,400.00	610.58	172,000.00	577.56	70,000.00	302.12
5/19/2025	459.02	39,200.00	610.58	172,000.00	577.56	70,000.00	302.12
5/20/2025	455.45	39,000.00	614.13	173,000.00	569.31	69,000.00	302.12
5/21/2025	453.17	38,800.00	614.13	173,000.00	568.48	68,900.00	299.57
5/22/2025	448.84	38,600.00	614.13	173,000.00	556.93	67,500.00	299.57
5/23/2025	449.57	38,600.00	614.13	173,000.00	556.93	67,500.00	299.57



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